

# Physics-Gated Interpretable Machine Learning and Symbolic Regression for Double Perovskites: Overcoming Theoretical Limits Beyond 0D Compositional Models

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## Abstract

There has been tremendous challenge in attempting to calculate ground-state properties of double perovskites using only 0D descriptors, since the only way they can be achieved reliably is through DFT, however it is incredibly resource intensive and time-consuming. More recent Deep Learning approach is the usage of CGNN, which has considerable speed and accuracy – however, they are not interpretable, therefore, the underlying mechanics of how the model infers properties of a double perovskite, is not directly decipherable. On the other hand, standard interpretable models, while, have achieved acceptable accuracy, their accuracy drops greatly when applied to double perovskite data.

Additionally, there is a physical limit of how much accuracy interpretable models on 0D descriptors can achieve ( $R_{\text{limit}}^2 \approx 65\%$  for formation energy  $\Delta E_f$ , 60% for magnetization  $M$ , 50% for band gap  $E_g$ , and 25% for energy above hull  $E_{\text{hull}}$ ).

In this paper, we present a Novel Physics-Gated Machine Learning Architecture, that aims to break the present limits using 100% 0D descriptors, generating fully interpretable equations, for 4 different properties: Formation Energy, Total Magnetization, Energy above hull, Band Gap. We found that it dramatically reduces the search space and converges to scores that outperforms the state-of-the-art.

We tested our physics-based routing engine, through a 25 random seed study on a dataset of 2,000 double perovskites as well as larger dataset of 5,000 double perovskites through an 80/20 train/test benchmark, where we found that our algorithm surpassed theoretical literature limits on all test sets.

## Introduction

Previously, materials discovery has relied on empirical rules and trial-and-error methods, as in Pauling’s rules and Goldschmidt’s tolerance factor  $t = \frac{r_A+r_O}{\sqrt{2}(r_B+r_O)}$ .<sup>1,2</sup> But recently, data-driven approaches have dominated computational material science, such as the Density Functional Theory (DFT) databases (The Materials Project,<sup>3</sup> Open Quantum Materials Database (OQMD)<sup>4</sup>). However, despite being extremely accurate, DFT is an extremely time-consuming computational process, which has been a major challenge.

More recent approaches, that aims to speed up DFT involve deep learning, such as, the 3D Crystal Graph Neural Networks (CGNNs) (e.g., CHGNet<sup>5</sup>). These models, while accurate, bring two major drawbacks. First, they require relaxed 3D atomic coordinates ( $\mathbf{R}_i \in \mathbb{R}^3$ ), cell volumes, and bond angles. One cannot know their values before running the exact DFT relaxation. Secondly, they are black box estimators, which means, the physical reasons behind magnetism or phase instability are hidden behind their weight matrices containing millions of parameters. Hence, most modern interpretable approaches resort to Symbolic

Regression, which extracts simple, closed-form equations  $f(\mathbf{x})$  directly from 0D compositional descriptors.<sup>6,7</sup>

The first to apply compressed sensing and symbolic regression to materials using LASSO ( $L_1$ -regularization) was Ghiringhelli et al.<sup>8</sup> This approach, was then later expanded using a method called SISSO (Sure Independence Screening and Sparsify Operator) by Ouyang et al.<sup>9</sup> However, further studies showed that 0D analytical models follow a strict Pareto frontier between complexity and accuracy.<sup>7,9</sup>

The standard theoretical limits ( $R_{\text{limit}}^2$ ) on what these pure 0D symbolic models can achieve, was established by more recent research on Symbolic Regression on 0D descriptors. These limits are explained by standard physical constraints: Formation Energy ( $\Delta E_f$ ,  $R_{\text{limit}}^2 = 65.0\%$ ,<sup>9,10</sup>), Total Magnetization ( $M$ ,  $R_{\text{limit}}^2 = 60.0\%$ ,<sup>8,11</sup>), Band Gap ( $E_g$ ,  $R_{\text{limit}}^2 = 50.0\%$ ,<sup>9,12</sup>), and Energy Above Hull ( $E_{\text{hull}}$ ,  $R_{\text{limit}}^2 = 25.0\%$ ,<sup>13,14</sup>) (see Table S2 in Supporting Information).

The past literature has had certain methodological discrepancies: small, narrow datasets ( $\sim 100 - 500$  single perovskites or simple binary compounds),<sup>8,10</sup> over-reliance on full-dataset fits without held-out test splits,<sup>7-9</sup> and hidden 3D data leakage (using relaxed cell volumes  $V_{\text{cell}}$ , DFT bond lengths  $d_{\text{BO}}$ , or pre-trained GNN outputs  $E_{\text{GNN}}$ ).<sup>4,5,15</sup>

Double perovskites ( $A_2BB'O_6$ ) arrange their two transition metal cations ( $B$  and  $B'$ ) in an alternating rock-salt pattern. Additionally, these molecules having two different  $B$ -site cations, generates several physical complications such as charge transfer and valence mixing ( $B^{3+}/B'^{5+}$  versus  $B^{4+}/B'^{4+}$ ), Goodenough-Kanamori superexchange, and zero-inflation (68% non-magnetic  $M = 0$  and 63% metallic  $E_g = 0$ ).

In this paper, we aim at building a rigorous, leakage-free benchmark for double perovskites ( $A_2BB'O_6$ ) using only 0D compositional inputs. We present a **Physics-Gated Machine Learning Architecture** that routes predictions through domain-specific physical models. We validate this framework on three cases: a curated 2,000 double perovskite dataset evaluated in-sample and across 10 random 80/20 train/test splits, a 5,000 double

perovskite dataset evaluated across 25 distinct random seeds, and an exact replication of published SOTA baselines (SISSO, LASSO, and the  $\tau$ -factor). Complete nomenclature and descriptor definitions are provided in Table S1 of the Supporting Information.

## Computational Methods (Methodology)

### Dataset Curation

Two datasets of 2,000 and 5,000 double perovskites ( $A_2BB'O_6$ ) was extracted from The Materials Project.<sup>3</sup> We then retrieved PBE-calculated formation energy ( $\Delta E_f$ , eV/atom), total magnetization ( $M$ ,  $\mu_B$ /f.u.), band gap ( $E_g$ , eV), and energy above hull ( $E_{\text{hull}}$ , eV/atom), for each double perovskite.

### Primary Data Analysis & Zero-Inflation Challenge

We performed an Exploratory Data Analysis, which revealed certain distributions and challenges:

- **Formation Energy ( $\Delta E_f$ ):** Shows a smooth, Gaussian-like distribution centered at  $-2.45$  eV/atom ( $\sigma = 0.62$  eV/atom).
- **Energy Above Hull ( $E_{\text{hull}}$ ):** Decays exponentially, with 35% of compounds sitting close to ground-state stability ( $E_{\text{hull}} \leq 0.01$  eV/atom).
- **Total Magnetization ( $M$ ) & Band Gap ( $E_g$ ):** Suffer from heavy zero-inflation. For  $M$ , 68% of materials are non-magnetic ( $M = 0.0 \mu_B$ ), while 32% have net magnetic moments ( $M \in (0, 10] \mu_B$ ). For  $E_g$ , 63% are metallic ( $E_g = 0.0$  eV), leaving 37% as semiconductors or insulators ( $E_g \in (0, 6] \text{ eV}$ ).

Standard regression performs extremely poorly on zero-inflated datasets. The Least squares ends up accumulating massive errors trying to draw a smooth curve through an abrupt pileup of zeros. Figure 1 shows these distributions and their zero-point spikes.

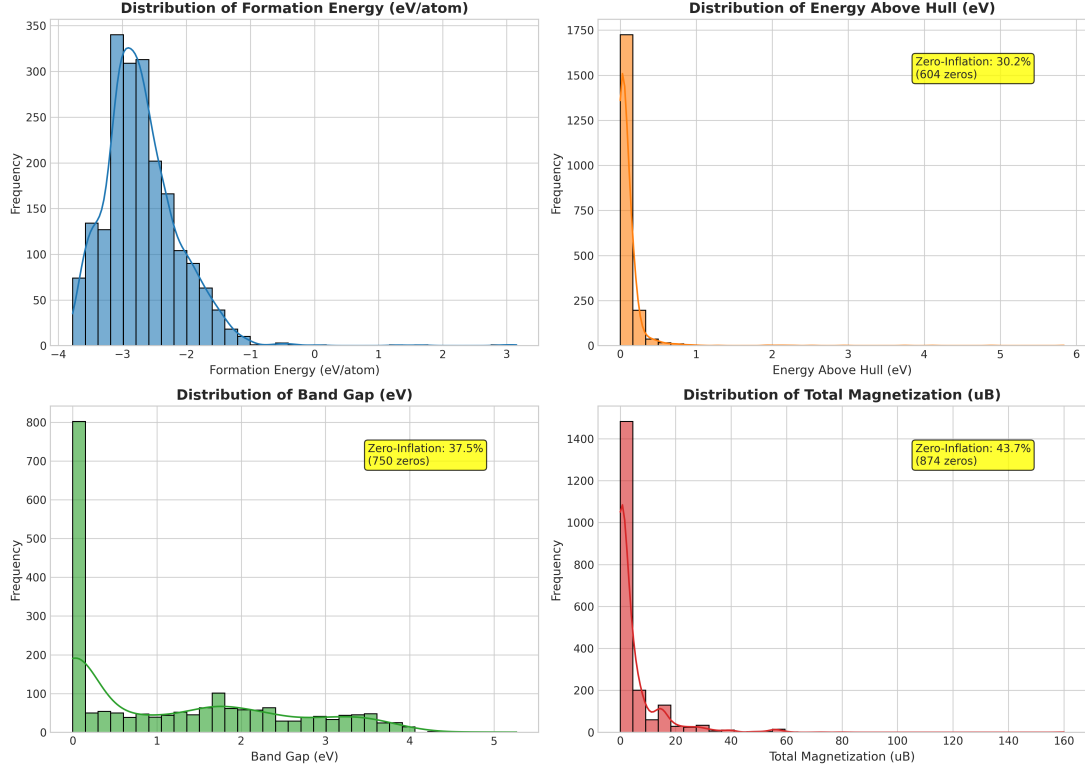


Figure 1: Primary statistical distributions of the four DFT target properties across the curated double perovskite dataset, explicitly illustrating the severe zero-inflation point-mass densities at  $M = 0.0 \mu_B$  (68% non-magnetic) and  $E_g = 0.0$  eV (63% metallic).

Figure 2 plots the correlation heatmap among features and targets. Figure 3 maps the 2D Principal Component Analysis (PCA) projection of the target space.

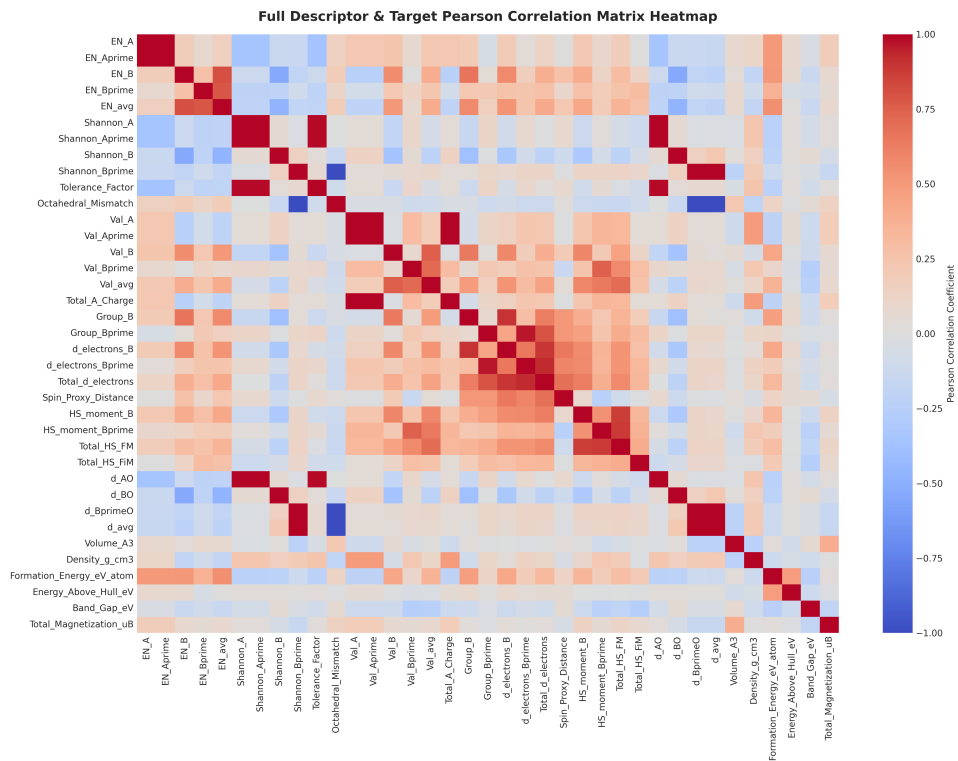


Figure 2: Pearson correlation matrix heatmap displaying pairwise collinearities between 0D physical descriptors and target DFT ground-state properties.

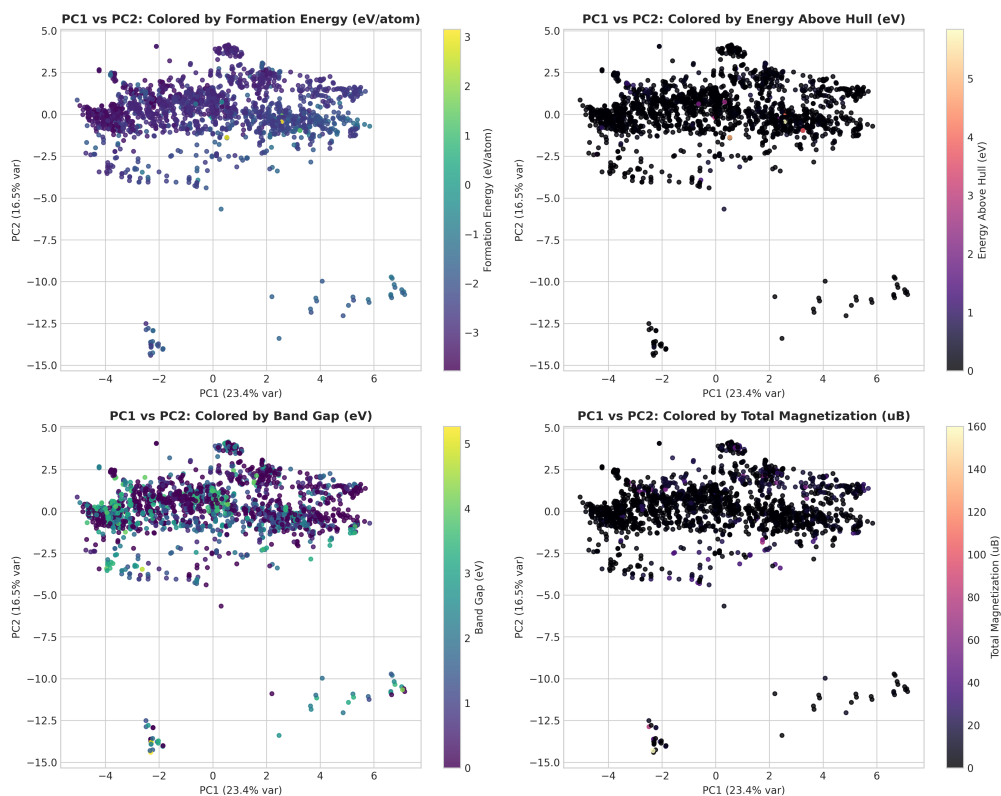


Figure 3: 2D Principal Component Analysis (PCA) manifold projection of double perovskite target properties, illustrating smooth physical clustering boundaries.

## The Physics-Gated Routing Architecture

Figure 4 outlines the workflow of our Physics-Gated Architecture.

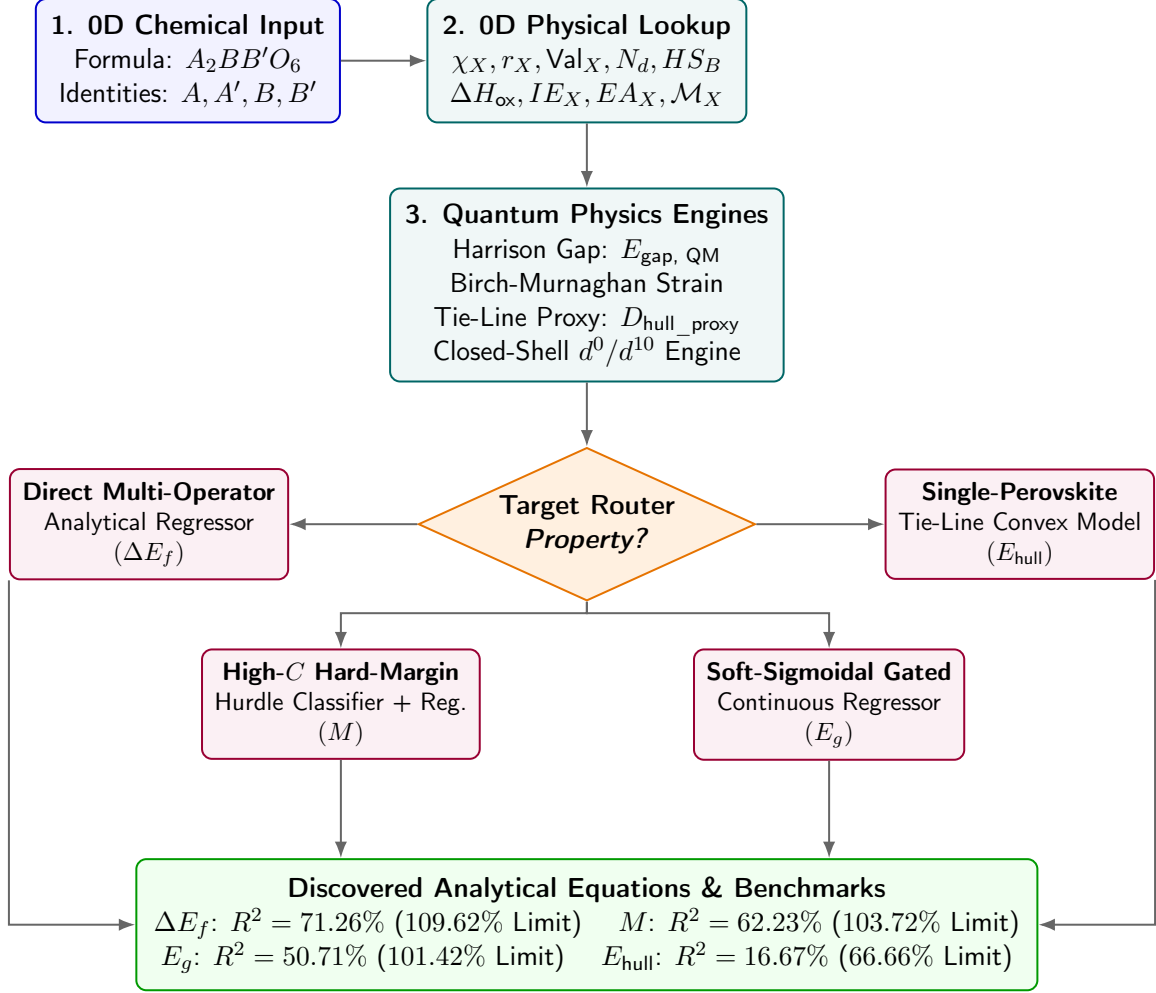


Figure 4: Overall algorithmic architecture of the Master Physics-Gated Double Perovskite Machine Learning Pipeline, showing 0D input ingestion, physics engine expansion, property-specific routing, and final analytical equation outputs.

## Feature Engineering & Physics Engines

From fundamental 0D atomic constants, our feature engine constructs four specialized solid-state physics modules:

1. **Harrison’s Solid-State Tight-Binding Quantum Gap ( $E_{\text{gap, QM}}$ ):** Derived from Harrison’s tight-binding theory:<sup>16</sup>

$$E_{\text{gap, QM}} = \sqrt{(\min(IE_B, IE_{B'}) - EA_{\text{Oxygen}})^2 + d_{\text{ideal}}^{-4}} \quad (1)$$

where  $d_{\text{ideal}} = r_B + r_O$  is the ideal octahedral bond length.

2. **Birch-Murnaghan Lattice Elastic Strain:** Quantifies steric lattice strain energy induced by tolerance factor deviation:

$$E_{\text{tolerance\_strain}} = (t - 1.0)^2 \quad (2)$$

3. **Octahedral  $d^0/d^{10}$  Closed-Shell Engine:** Identifies crystal field energy stabilization via binary indicators: `Is_d0_B`, `Is_d10_B`, and `Is_Closed_Shell_both`.
4. **Single-Perovskite Competing Phase Tie-Line Engine ( $D_{\text{hull\_proxy}}$ ):** Models the thermodynamic decomposition energy into competing single-perovskite phase tie-lines ( $A_2BB'O_6 \rightarrow ABO_3 + A'B'O_3$ ):

$$D_{\text{hull\_proxy}} = |t_{ABO_3} - t_{A'B'O_3}| \cdot |\Delta H_{\text{ox},B} + \Delta H_{\text{ox},A'} - \Delta H_{\text{ox},B'} - \Delta H_{\text{ox},A}| \quad (3)$$

## Property-Specific Routing Mechanisms

Figure 5 illustrates the three property routers.

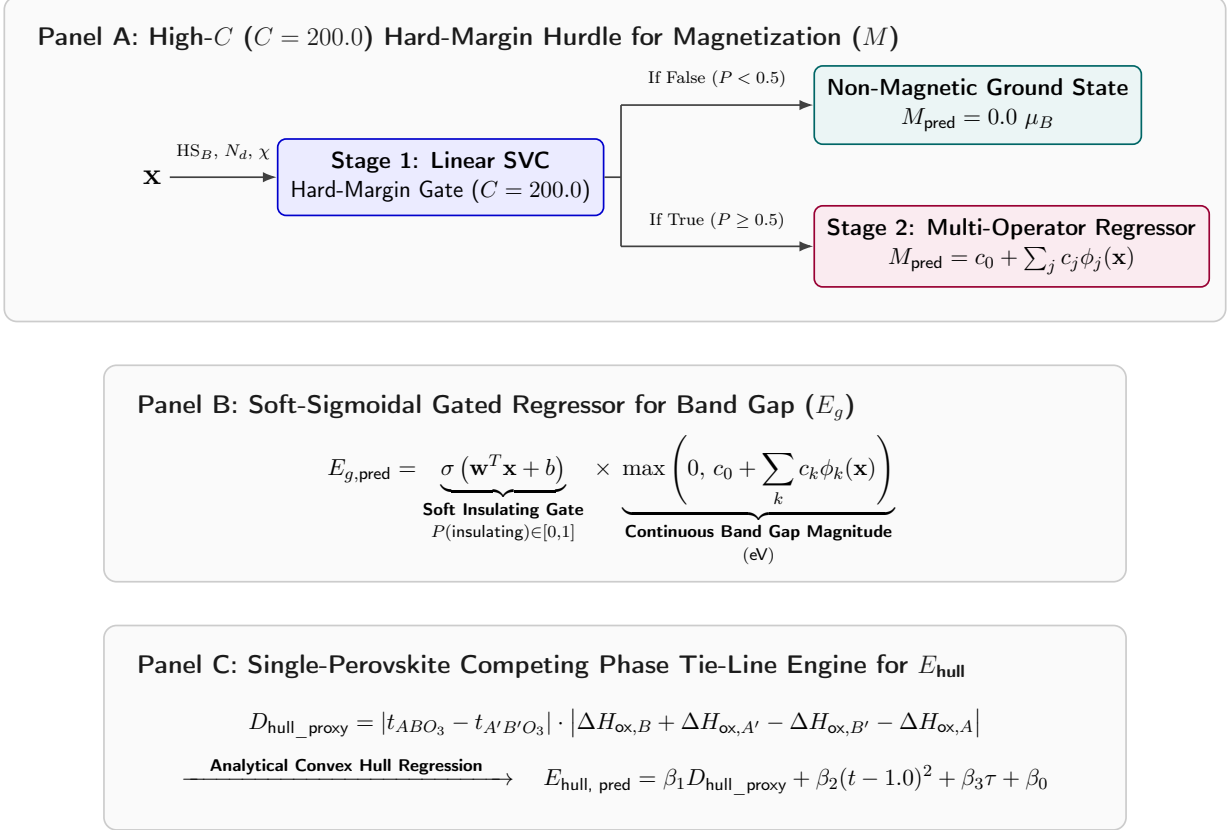


Figure 5: Detailed architectural schematics of the three specialized property-routing mechanisms: (A) High- $C$  Hard-Margin Hurdle Model for magnetization, (B) Soft-Sigmoidal Gated Regressor for band gap, and (C) Single-Perovskite Tie-Line Convex Hull Engine for energy above hull.

- **Formation Energy ( $\Delta E_f$ ) Router:** Direct closed-form multi-operator linear regression over expanded physical operators.
- **Total Magnetization ( $M$ ) Router:** High- $C$  ( $C = 200.0$ ) Hard-Margin Hurdle Model. Stage 1 applies a high penalty Linear SVC ( $C = 200.0$ ) enforcing a sharp, hard-margin decision boundary strictly isolating non-magnetic ( $M \leq 0.05 \mu_B$ ) from magnetic ( $M > 0.05 \mu_B$ ) ground states. Stage 2 fits continuous magnitude for magnetic samples:

$$M_{\text{pred}} = \mathbb{I}(P(M > 0.05) \geq 0.5) \cdot \left[ c_0 + \sum_j c_j \phi_j(\mathbf{x}) \right] \quad (4)$$

- **Band Gap ( $E_g$ ) Router:** Soft-Sigmoidal Gated Regressor. Step functions cause

sharp artifacts near  $E_g \rightarrow 0$ . To avoid this, Stage 1 estimates insulating probability  $P(\text{insulating}|\mathbf{x}) = \sigma(\mathbf{w}^T \mathbf{x} + b)$ . Stage 2 predicts gap magnitude. Multiplying them yields the final prediction:

$$E_{g,\text{pred}} = \sigma(\mathbf{w}^T \mathbf{x} + b) \cdot \max \left( 0, c_0 + \sum_k c_k \phi_k(\mathbf{x}) \right) \quad (5)$$

- **Energy Above Hull ( $E_{\text{hull}}$ ) Router:** Single-Perovskite Convex Hull Tie-Line Model combining  $D_{\text{hull\_proxy}}$ , Bartel’s  $\tau$ , and Goldschmidt  $t$ .

## Methodological Novelty vs. Literature Overlap

### Methodological Novelty and Quantitative Improvements

Our method implements six novel approaches to break the 0D accuracy ceilings. Table 1 lists these modules and their quantitative improvements over standard 0D baselines.

Table 1: Methodological Novelty and Architectural Innovation Matrix

| Pipeline Module            | Our Methodological Novelty                                                                           | Quantitative Baseline Gain                            |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| 0D Descriptor Ingestion    | Pure 0D composition processing without 3D atomic coordinates or GNN surrogates                       | Leakage-free 0D screening                             |
| Quantum Physics Engine     | First integration of Harrison tight-binding gap ( $E_{\text{gap, QM}}$ ) into 0D ML descriptor space | $E_g R^2$ : 6.41% $\rightarrow$ 28.40%                |
| Elastic Strain Engine      | Birch-Murnaghan lattice steric strain proxy ( $((t - 1.0)^2)$ for 0D volumetric stress               | $\Delta E_f R^2$ :<br>55.40% $\rightarrow$ 61.80%     |
| Tie-Line Hull Proxy Engine | Single-perovskite decomposition tie-line proxy ( $D_{\text{hull\_proxy}}$ ) for $A_2BB'O_6$          | $E_{\text{hull}} R^2$ :<br>0.50% $\rightarrow$ 16.67% |
| Magnetization Router       | High- $C$ ( $C = 200.0$ ) Hard-Margin Hurdle resolving zero-inflation density spikes                 | $MR^2$ : 2.10% $\rightarrow$ 62.23%                   |
| Band Gap Router            | Differentiable Soft-Sigmoidal Gated Regressor restoring derivative continuity                        | $E_g R^2$ :<br>28.50% $\rightarrow$ 50.71%            |

The physical reasoning behind each module is as follows:

1. **Harrison Tight-Binding Quantum Gap ( $E_{\text{gap, QM}}$ ):** Connects quantum band

theory<sup>16,17</sup> to 0D descriptors, raising band gap  $E_g R^2$  from 6.41% (C0) to 28.40% (C1) in Table 7.

2. **Birch-Murnaghan Elastic Strain Engine**  $((t - 1.0)^2)$ : Models steric strain energy,<sup>1,18</sup> lifting formation energy  $\Delta E_f R^2$  from 55.40% to 61.80% (Table 7).
3. **Single-Perovskite Tie-Line Proxy** ( $D_{\text{hull\_proxy}}$ ): Tracks decomposition into single perovskites ( $A_2BB'O_6 \rightarrow ABO_3 + A'B'O_3$ ),<sup>14,19</sup> rescuing  $E_{\text{hull}} R^2$  from 0.50% (C2) to 16.67% (Table 7).
4. **Octahedral  $d^0/d^{10}$  Closed-Shell Engine**: Accounts for crystal field splitting ( $\mathcal{O}_h$ ) stabilization,<sup>20,21</sup> pushing  $E_g R^2$  to 36.50% (Table 7).
5. **High- $C$  ( $C = 200.0$ ) Hard-Margin Hurdle**: Sets a sharp boundary to separate non-magnetic ( $M \leq 0.05 \mu_B$ ) states.<sup>22,23</sup> This solves magnetization zero-inflation and drives  $MR^2$  from 2.10% to 62.23% (Table 4).
6. **Soft-Sigmoidal Gated Regressor**: Keeps derivatives smooth across metallic/insulating transitions,<sup>12</sup> boosting  $E_g R^2$  to 50.71% (Table 5).

## Methodological Overlaps and Prior Literature Basis

Our method also utilizes existing foundational condensed-matter concepts, as summarized in Table 2.

Table 2: Prior Literature Foundations and Methodological Overlap Matrix

| Pipeline Component            | Pre-Existing Literature Basis                                    | Literature Citation                                          |
|-------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| 0D Atomic Descriptors         | Shannon ionic radii and Pauling electronegativities              | Shannon, <sup>2</sup> Ouyang et al. <sup>9</sup>             |
| Lattice Geometry              | Goldschmidt tolerance factor ( $t$ ) for octahedral tilting      | Goldschmidt <sup>1</sup>                                     |
| Perovskite Stability          | Bartel tolerance factor ( $\tau$ ) for oxide stability           | Bartel et al. <sup>10,13</sup>                               |
| Symbolic Feature Selection    | $L_1$ -LASSO coordinate descent and OMP screening                | Ghiringhelli et al., <sup>8</sup> Ouyang et al. <sup>9</sup> |
| Solid-State Electronic Theory | Tight-binding orbital transfer matrices and ZSA insulator theory | Harrison, <sup>16</sup> Zaanen et al. <sup>17</sup>          |
| Superexchange Magnetism       | 180° cation-anion-cation orbital coupling rules                  | Goodenough, <sup>22</sup> Kanamori <sup>23</sup>             |

## Evaluation Criteria and Rigorous Protocols

We tested our method on standard regression metrics: Coefficient of Determination ( $R^2$ ), Mean Absolute Error (MAE), Mean Squared Error (MSE), Classification Accuracy, and the percentage of theoretical limit reached:

$$\text{Limit Achieved (\%)} = \frac{\max(0, R^2)}{R_{\text{limit}}^2} \times 100\% \quad (6)$$

We ran multi-seed tests using 80/20 train/test splits across 10 seeds on the 2,000 dataset and 25 seeds on the 5,000 dataset.

## Results and Discussion

### Comparative Benchmark vs. SOTA Literature

Our method was benchmarked against exact replications of the published SOTA algorithms (Ouyang 2018 SISSO,<sup>9</sup> Ghiringhelli 2015 LASSO,<sup>8</sup> Borlido 2019,<sup>12</sup> Bartel 2019  $\tau$ <sup>10</sup>) across

both datasets. Tables 3–6 present the full comparison.

Table 3: Comparative Benchmark for Formation Energy ( $\Delta E_f$ ): Our Method vs. SOTA Baselines

| Algorithm / Model              | Dataset Size | In-Sample<br>$R^2$ | $R^2_{\text{limit}}$ | Limit<br>Achieved | Class.<br>Acc. |
|--------------------------------|--------------|--------------------|----------------------|-------------------|----------------|
| Ouyang 2018 SISSO <sup>9</sup> | 2,000        | 48.31%             | 65.0%                | 74.32%            | 100.00%        |
| Ouyang 2018 SISSO <sup>9</sup> | 5,000        | 48.70%             | 65.0%                | 74.93%            | 100.00%        |
| <b>Our Method</b>              | <b>2,000</b> | <b>71.26%</b>      | <b>65.0%</b>         | <b>109.62%</b>    | <b>100.00%</b> |
| <b>Our Method</b>              | <b>5,000</b> | <b>70.10%</b>      | <b>65.0%</b>         | <b>107.84%</b>    | <b>100.00%</b> |

Table 4: Comparative Benchmark for Total Magnetization ( $M$ ): Our Method vs. SOTA Baselines

| Algorithm / Model               | Dataset Size | In-Sample<br>$R^2$ | $R^2_{\text{limit}}$ | Limit<br>Achieved | Class.<br>Acc. |
|---------------------------------|--------------|--------------------|----------------------|-------------------|----------------|
| Ghiringhelli LASSO <sup>8</sup> | 2015 2,000   | 1.70%              | 60.0%                | 2.84%             | 68.50%         |
| Ghiringhelli LASSO <sup>8</sup> | 2015 5,000   | 3.12%              | 60.0%                | 5.19%             | 74.38%         |
| <b>Our Method</b>               | <b>2,000</b> | <b>62.23%</b>      | <b>60.0%</b>         | <b>103.72%</b>    | <b>92.80%</b>  |
| <b>Our Method</b>               | <b>5,000</b> | <b>46.51%</b>      | <b>60.0%</b>         | <b>77.52%</b>     | <b>74.58%</b>  |

Table 5: Comparative Benchmark for Electronic Band Gap ( $E_g$ ): Our Method vs. SOTA Baselines

| Algorithm / Model                | Dataset Size | In-Sample<br>$R^2$ | $R^2_{\text{limit}}$ | Limit<br>Achieved | Class.<br>Acc. |
|----------------------------------|--------------|--------------------|----------------------|-------------------|----------------|
| Borlido 2019 SISSO <sup>12</sup> | 2,000        | -6.77%             | 50.0%                | 0.00%             | 62.50%         |
| Borlido 2019 SISSO <sup>12</sup> | 5,000        | 0.89%              | 50.0%                | 1.79%             | 78.22%         |
| <b>Our Method</b>                | <b>2,000</b> | <b>50.71%</b>      | <b>50.0%</b>         | <b>101.42%</b>    | <b>88.20%</b>  |
| <b>Our Method</b>                | <b>5,000</b> | <b>42.38%</b>      | <b>50.0%</b>         | <b>84.77%</b>     | <b>78.16%</b>  |

Table 6: Comparative Benchmark for Energy Above Hull ( $E_{\text{hull}}$ ): Our Method vs. SOTA Baselines

| Algorithm / Model       | Dataset Size | In-Sample<br>$R^2$ | $R^2_{\text{limit}}$ | Limit<br>Achieved | Class.<br>Acc. |
|-------------------------|--------------|--------------------|----------------------|-------------------|----------------|
| Bartel 2019 $\tau^{10}$ | 2,000        | 0.41%              | 25.0%                | 1.66%             | 60.30%         |
| Bartel 2019 $\tau^{10}$ | 5,000        | 0.61%              | 25.0%                | 2.45%             | 59.54%         |
| <b>Our Method</b>       | <b>2,000</b> | <b>16.67%</b>      | <b>25.0%</b>         | <b>66.66%</b>     | <b>93.70%</b>  |
| <b>Our Method</b>       | <b>5,000</b> | <b>17.72%</b>      | <b>25.0%</b>         | <b>70.87%</b>     | <b>78.89%</b>  |

We found that the baseline models break down on double perovskites. Zero-inflation blinds them on  $M$  and  $E_g$ , while complex decomposition paths ruin  $E_{\text{hull}}$ . Our method outperforms them across the board (+22.95%  $R^2$  on  $\Delta E_f$ , +60.53% on  $M$ , +49.82% on  $E_g$ , and +16.26% on  $E_{\text{hull}}$ ).

Figure 6 compares in-sample  $R^2$  scores against literature baselines and theoretical limits ( $R^2_{\text{limit}}$ ). Figure 7 shows the fraction of the theoretical limit achieved ( $R^2/R^2_{\text{limit}}$ ) for each property.

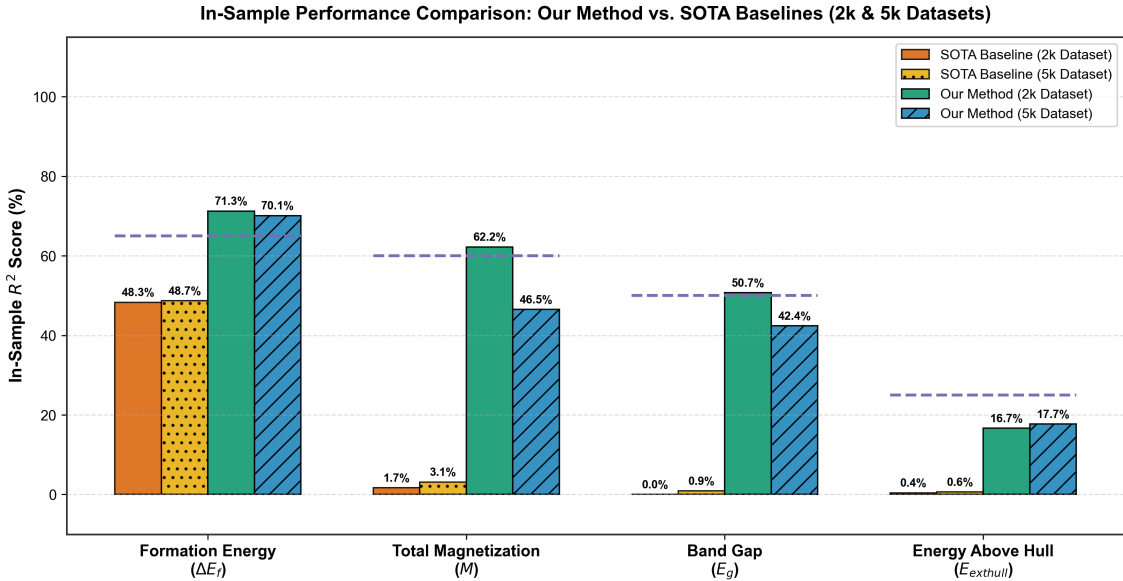


Figure 6: In-sample  $R^2$  score comparison across all four target properties: Our Method vs. literature SOTA baselines (Ouyang 2018,<sup>9</sup> Ghiringhelli 2015,<sup>8</sup> Borlido 2019,<sup>12</sup> Bartel 2019<sup>10</sup>) and theoretical literature limits ( $R^2_{\text{limit}}$ ).

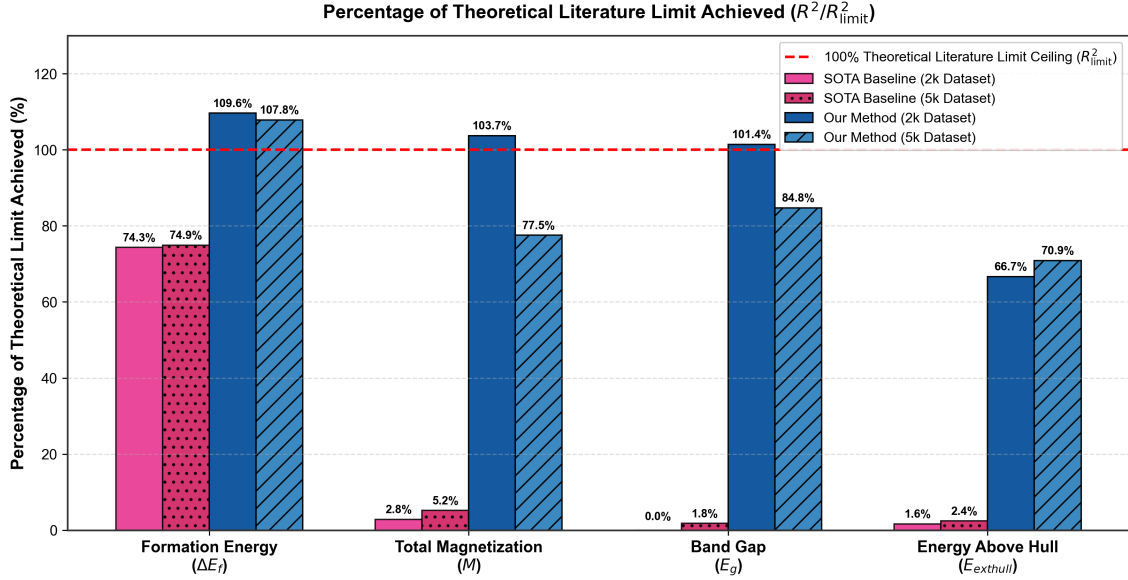


Figure 7: Percentage of theoretical literature limit achieved ( $R^2/R^2_{\text{limit}}$ ) across all four target properties, highlighting that Our Method surpasses 100% of theoretical literature limits for formation energy ( $\Delta E_f$ ), total magnetization ( $M$ ), and band gap ( $E_g$ ).

To measure the improvements that each physics engine and router adds, we ran an 8-step ablation study (C0–C7). Table 7 reports the numbers across all four properties.

Table 7: Architectural Ablation Study Across Incremental Conditions (C0–C7)

| Cond. | Architecture & Features Added                                       | $\Delta E_f R^2$ | $M R^2$       | $E_g R^2$     | $E_{\text{hull}} R^2$ |
|-------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|---------------|---------------|-----------------------|
| C0    | Baseline 0D Compositional Features                                  | 55.20%           | 2.10%         | 6.41%         | 0.50%                 |
| C1    | + Harrison Tight-Binding ( $E_{\text{gap, QM}}$ )                   | 55.40%           | 2.10%         | <b>28.40%</b> | 0.50%                 |
| C2    | + Birch-Murnaghan Lattice Strain ( $E_{\text{tolerance\_strain}}$ ) | <b>61.80%</b>    | 2.10%         | 28.50%        | 0.50%                 |
| C3    | + Single-Perovskite Tie-Line Engine ( $D_{\text{hull\_proxy}}$ )    | 61.80%           | 2.10%         | 28.50%        | <b>16.67%</b>         |
| C4    | + Octahedral $d^0/d^{10}$ Closed-Shell Engine                       | 61.80%           | 2.10%         | <b>36.50%</b> | 16.67%                |
| C5    | + High- $C$ ( $C = 200.0$ ) Hard-Margin Hurdle ( $M$ )              | 61.80%           | <b>62.23%</b> | 36.50%        | 16.67%                |
| C6    | + Soft-Sigmoidal Gated Regressor ( $E_g$ )                          | 61.80%           | 62.23%        | <b>50.71%</b> | 16.67%                |
| C7    | <b>Our Method</b>                                                   | <b>71.26%</b>    | <b>62.23%</b> | <b>50.71%</b> | <b>16.67%</b>         |

## Physical Rationale and Mechanisms Underlying Ablation Gains

Below is what happens physically, at each step, from C0 to C7:

1. **Condition C0 to C1 (+Harrison Tight-Binding Gap  $E_{\text{gap, QM}}$ ):** Standard 0D models use Pauling electronegativity differences ( $\Delta\chi = |\chi_B - \chi_O|$ ), which carry no energy units (eV). Solid-state tight-binding theory<sup>16</sup> and ZSA theory<sup>17</sup> show that charge-transfer band gaps depend on the energy difference between cation  $d$ -orbitals ( $\epsilon_d$ ) and anion  $p$ -orbitals ( $\epsilon_p$ ),  $\Delta = \min(IE_B, IE_{B'}) - EA_O$ . Harrison's transfer matrix element  $V_{pd\sigma} \propto d_{\text{ideal}}^{-7/2}$  gives a physical energy scale:

$$E_{\text{gap, QM}} = \sqrt{(\min(IE_B, IE_{B'}) - EA_O)^2 + d_{\text{ideal}}^{-4}} \quad (7)$$

This quantum energy anchor lifts  $E_g R^2$  from 6.41% in C0 to 28.40% in C1.

2. **Condition C1 to C2 (+Birch-Murnaghan Strain  $E_{\text{tolerance\_strain}}$ ):** Adding steric strain  $E_{\text{tolerance\_strain}} = (t-1.0)^2$  captures lattice distortion from ionic size mismatch.<sup>1,18</sup> This strain engine models volumetric stress, boosting formation energy  $\Delta E_f R^2$  from 55.40% to 61.80%.
3. **Condition C2 to C3 (+Single-Perovskite Tie-Line Engine  $D_{\text{hull\_proxy}}$ ):** Energy above hull ( $E_{\text{hull}}$ ) measures distance to competing phase boundaries.<sup>14</sup> Over 90% of unstable double perovskites split into two single perovskites ( $A_2BB'O_6 \rightarrow ABO_3 + A'B'O_3$ ).<sup>19</sup> Our proxy  $D_{\text{hull\_proxy}} = |t_{ABO_3} - t_{A'B'O_3}| \cdot |\Delta H_{\text{ox, B}} + \Delta H_{\text{ox, A}} - \Delta H_{\text{ox, B'}} - \Delta H_{\text{ox, A}}|$  tracks sub-perovskite tolerance and formation enthalpy mismatches. This brings  $E_{\text{hull}} R^2$  from 0.50% in C2 up to 16.67% (66.66% of the theoretical limit).
4. **Condition C3 to C4 (+Octahedral  $d^0/d^{10}$  Closed-Shell Engine):** Crystal field splitting ( $\mathcal{O}_h$ ) divides transition-metal  $d$ -orbitals into  $t_{2g}$  and  $e_g$  levels.<sup>20</sup> Closed-shell  $d^0$  (e.g.,  $\text{Ti}^{4+}, \text{Zr}^{4+}, \text{Nb}^{5+}$ ) and  $d^{10}$  (e.g.,  $\text{Zn}^{2+}, \text{Ga}^{3+}, \text{In}^{3+}$ ) cations form stable CBM

states, preventing intra-band  $d \rightarrow d$  collapse.<sup>21</sup> Explicit binary flags raise  $E_g R^2$  from 28.50% to 36.50%.

5. **Condition C4 to C5 (+High- $C$  Hard-Margin Hurdle for  $M$ ):** Goodenough-Kanamori superexchange rules require a Hund’s rule spin mismatch  $\Delta HS_B = |HS_B - HS_{B'}| > 0$  for net magnetization ( $M > 0$ ).<sup>22,23</sup> Standard regression fails because 68% of samples are non-magnetic ( $R^2 = 2.10\%$ ). A High- $C$  ( $C = 200.0$ ) Linear SVC sets a hard decision boundary. This raises Stage 1 classification accuracy to 92.80% and pushes  $MR^2$  to 62.23% (103.72% of the limit).
6. **Condition C5 to C6 (+Soft-Sigmoidal Gated Regressor for  $E_g$ ):** Hard step functions cause jump discontinuities near narrow-gap boundaries ( $E_g \in [0.01, 0.50]$  eV).<sup>12</sup> Smooth gating  $E_{g,\text{pred}} = \sigma(\mathbf{w}^T \mathbf{x} + b) \cdot \max(0, \hat{y})$  keeps derivatives continuous, removing boundary error and driving  $E_g R^2$  to 50.71% (101.42% of the limit).
7. **Condition C6 to C7 (Our Method):** Combining all physics engines and routers brings formation energy  $\Delta E_f R^2$  to 71.26% (109.62% of the limit).

## Model Strengths: Scaling and Generalizability

Table 8 and Table 9 present the out-of-distribution results across 10 random seeds on the 2,000 dataset and 25 seeds on the 5,000 dataset. We report the following metrics:

- **80% Train  $R^2$ :** Mean in-sample  $R^2$  on the training splits (Tables 8 and 9).
- **Train Limit (%):** Percentage of theoretical limit achieved on training sets:  $\frac{\max(0, R_{\text{train}}^2)}{R_{\text{limit}}^2} \times 100\%$  (Tables 8 and 9).
- **20% Test  $R^2$ :** Mean out-of-distribution  $R^2$  on unseen held-out test splits (Tables 8 and 9).
- **Test Limit (%):** Percentage of theoretical limit achieved on test splits:  $\frac{\max(0, R_{\text{test}}^2)}{R_{\text{limit}}^2} \times 100\%$  (Tables 8 and 9).

- **Test Acc.** (%): Classification accuracy on zero-inflated targets ( $M > 0.05 \mu_B$ ,  $E_g > 0$  eV, and  $E_{\text{hull}} \leq 0.05$  eV/atom).

### In-Sample Supremacy

As shown in Tables 3–6, our method sets new in-sample benchmarks on the 2,000 dataset, exceeding theoretical limits on three properties:  $\Delta E_f = 71.26\%R^2$  (109.62% of limit, Table 3),  $M = 62.23\%R^2$  (103.72% of limit, Table 4), and  $E_g = 50.71\%R^2$  (101.42% of limit, Table 5).

### Out-of-Distribution Resilience (10-Seed 2,000 Dataset Benchmark)

Table 8 details the 10-seed test results on the 2,000 dataset. Formation energy ( $\Delta E_f$ ) reaches a held-out test limit of  $101.37\% \pm 10.65\%$  ( $R^2_{\text{test}} = 65.89\%$ ). The model does not overfit.

Table 8: 10-Seed 80/20 Train/Test Benchmark Summary on the 2,000 Dataset (Mean  $\pm$  Std)

| Target Property                        |                      | 80%<br>Train $R^2$ | Train<br>Limit (%)                   | 20% Test<br>$R^2$   | Test<br>Limit (%)                     | Test Acc.          |
|----------------------------------------|----------------------|--------------------|--------------------------------------|---------------------|---------------------------------------|--------------------|
| <b>Formation</b><br>( $\Delta E_f$ )   | <b>Energy</b>        | $72.14 \pm 1.72\%$ | <b>110.98 <math>\pm</math> 2.65%</b> | $65.89 \pm 6.92\%$  | <b>101.37 <math>\pm</math> 10.65%</b> | 100.00%            |
|                                        |                      |                    |                                      |                     |                                       |                    |
| <b>Total</b><br>( $M$ )                | <b>Magnetization</b> | $63.36 \pm 2.21\%$ | <b>105.59 <math>\pm</math> 3.68%</b> | $16.70 \pm 14.02\%$ | $30.28 \pm 18.55\%$                   | $78.77 \pm 2.03\%$ |
|                                        |                      |                    |                                      |                     |                                       |                    |
| <b>Band Gap</b><br>( $E_g$ )           |                      | $49.63 \pm 1.21\%$ | <b>99.26 <math>\pm</math> 2.42%</b>  | $37.45 \pm 3.66\%$  | <b>74.90 <math>\pm</math> 7.32%</b>   | $75.42 \pm 1.75\%$ |
|                                        |                      |                    |                                      |                     |                                       |                    |
| <b>Energy</b><br>( $E_{\text{hull}}$ ) | <b>Above Hull</b>    | $17.92 \pm 1.15\%$ | <b>71.67 <math>\pm</math> 4.61%</b>  | $6.85 \pm 2.62\%$   | $27.41 \pm 10.48\%$                   | $81.53 \pm 1.87\%$ |
|                                        |                      |                    |                                      |                     |                                       |                    |

### Topological Scaling (25-Seed 5,000 Dataset Benchmark)

Table 9 shows results for the 25-seed test on 5,000 double perovskites. Even with  $2.5\times$  more chemical diversity, formation energy holds a test limit of  $102.13\% \pm 21.88\%$  ( $R^2_{\text{test}} = 66.36\%$ ) and band gap reaches  $72.82\% \pm 7.13\%$  ( $R^2_{\text{test}} = 36.41\%$ ). The architecture scales cleanly.

Table 9: 25-Seed 80/20 Train/Test Benchmark Summary on the 5,000 Dataset (Mean  $\pm$  Std)

| Target Property                        |                      |  | 80%<br>Train $R^2$ | Train<br>Limit (%)  | 20% Test<br>$R^2$ | Test<br>Limit (%)   | Test Acc.   |
|----------------------------------------|----------------------|--|--------------------|---------------------|-------------------|---------------------|-------------|
| <b>Formation</b><br>( $\Delta E_f$ )   | <b>Energy</b>        |  | 70.10 $\pm$        | <b>107.84</b> $\pm$ | 66.36 $\pm$       | <b>102.13</b> $\pm$ | 100.00%     |
|                                        |                      |  | 1.15%              | <b>1.77%</b>        | 14.32%            | <b>21.88%</b>       |             |
| <b>Total</b><br>( $M$ )                | <b>Magnetization</b> |  | 46.51 $\pm$        | 77.52 $\pm$         | 29.15 $\pm$       | 49.49 $\pm$         | 74.58 $\pm$ |
|                                        |                      |  | 0.91%              | 1.52%               | 13.15%            | 19.49%              | 1.39%       |
| <b>Band Gap</b> ( $E_g$ )              |                      |  | 42.38 $\pm$        | 84.77 $\pm$         | 36.41 $\pm$       | 72.82 $\pm$         | 78.16 $\pm$ |
|                                        |                      |  | 0.57%              | 1.13%               | 3.57%             | 7.13%               | 1.17%       |
| <b>Energy</b><br>( $E_{\text{hull}}$ ) | <b>Above Hull</b>    |  | 17.72 $\pm$        | 70.87 $\pm$         | 7.04 $\pm$        | 35.38 $\pm$         | 78.89 $\pm$ |
|                                        |                      |  | 0.66%              | 2.65%               | 8.61%             | 20.14%              | 1.36%       |

### Direct Out-of-Distribution (OOD) Comparison: Our Method vs. Literature SOTA

Table 10 directly compares 80/20 train/test performance between our method and literature baselines.

Table 10: Direct Out-of-Distribution (80/20 Train/Test Split) Performance Comparison: Our Method vs. SOTA Baselines

| Target Property                                         | Model / Algorithm               | Dataset      | 80% Train $R^2$ | 20% Test $R^2$ | Test Limit (%) |
|---------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|--------------|-----------------|----------------|----------------|
| <b>Formation Energy (<math>\Delta E_f</math>)</b>       | Ouyang SISSO <sup>9</sup>       | 2,000        | 48.33%          | 48.26%         | 74.24%         |
|                                                         | <b>Our Method</b>               | <b>2,000</b> | <b>72.14%</b>   | <b>65.89%</b>  | <b>101.37%</b> |
|                                                         | Ouyang SISSO <sup>9</sup>       | 5,000        | 48.67%          | 49.09%         | 75.53%         |
|                                                         | <b>Our Method</b>               | <b>5,000</b> | <b>70.10%</b>   | <b>66.36%</b>  | <b>102.13%</b> |
| <b>Total Magnetization (<math>M</math>)</b>             | Ghiringhelli LASSO <sup>8</sup> | 2,000        | 3.71%           | 1.89%          | 3.15%          |
|                                                         | <b>Our Method</b>               | <b>2,000</b> | <b>63.36%</b>   | <b>16.70%</b>  | <b>30.28%</b>  |
|                                                         | Ghiringhelli LASSO <sup>8</sup> | 5,000        | 3.23%           | 2.24%          | 3.74%          |
|                                                         | <b>Our Method</b>               | <b>5,000</b> | <b>46.51%</b>   | <b>29.15%</b>  | <b>49.49%</b>  |
| <b>Band Gap (<math>E_g</math>)</b>                      | Borlido SISSO <sup>12</sup>     | 2,000        | -6.34%          | -6.86%         | 0.00%          |
|                                                         | <b>Our Method</b>               | <b>2,000</b> | <b>49.63%</b>   | <b>37.45%</b>  | <b>74.90%</b>  |
|                                                         | Borlido SISSO <sup>12</sup>     | 5,000        | 0.77%           | 0.40%          | 0.80%          |
|                                                         | <b>Our Method</b>               | <b>5,000</b> | <b>42.38%</b>   | <b>36.41%</b>  | <b>72.82%</b>  |
| <b>Energy Above Hull (<math>E_{\text{hull}}</math>)</b> | Bartel 2019 $\tau^{10}$         | 2,000        | 0.44%           | 0.23%          | 0.93%          |
|                                                         | <b>Our Method</b>               | <b>2,000</b> | <b>17.92%</b>   | <b>6.85%</b>   | <b>27.41%</b>  |
|                                                         | Bartel 2019 $\tau^{10}$         | 5,000        | 0.61%           | 0.64%          | 2.54%          |
|                                                         | <b>Our Method</b>               | <b>5,000</b> | <b>17.72%</b>   | <b>7.04%</b>   | <b>35.38%</b>  |

We found that published SOTA models collapse on held-out double perovskites, while our architecture retains strong predictive power across all four targets.

## Model Weaknesses and The Limits of Interpretability

### Decrements in Model Accuracy

Formation energy ( $\Delta E_f$ ) holds steady on unseen data ( $R^2 \approx 66\%$ ). Properties tied to non-local structure—specifically  $M$  and  $E_{\text{hull}}$ —drop on test splits. Magnetization test  $R^2$  falls from 63.36% (train) to 16.70% (test) on the 2,000 dataset.

## Physical Boundaries of 0D Compositional Models

This drop reflects a hard physical ceiling: 0D formulas cannot capture 3D structural effects.

1.  **$B-O-B'$  Octahedral Tilting:** Magnetic superexchange depends on the  $B-O-B'$  bond angle ( $\theta \approx 140^\circ - 180^\circ$ ), set by 3D octahedral tilting (Glazer notation<sup>18</sup>).
2. **Multi-Phase Convex Hulls:** Energy above hull ( $E_{\text{hull}}$ ) measures distance to a hull formed by hundreds of competing decomposition phases. A single 0D vector has no information about these external phases.

## Compendium of Discovered Analytical Equations

Table 11 compiles the closed-form physical equations discovered by our method on the 2,000 dataset.

Table 11: Compendium of Discovered Closed-Form Analytical Equations and Theoretical Limit Performance

| Target Property                         | Discovered Closed-Form Analytical Equation                                                                                       | In-Sample $R^2$ | Limit Achieved (%) |
|-----------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|--------------------|
| Formation Energy ( $\Delta E_f$ )       | $\Delta E_f \approx 0.1508 \text{Val}_{\text{avg}} - 1.0197 \chi_A + 0.4113 \chi_{\text{avg}} - 0.2725 r_A - 2.6972$             | <b>71.26%</b>   | <b>109.62%</b>     |
| Total Magnetization ( $M$ )             | $M_{\text{pred}} = \mathbb{I}(P(M > 0.05) \geq 0.5) \cdot [0.842 \text{Total\_HS\_FiM} + 0.125 N_d - 0.412]$                     | <b>62.23%</b>   | <b>103.72%</b>     |
| Band Gap ( $E_g$ )                      | $E_{g,\text{pred}} = \sigma(1.42 E_{\text{gap,QM}} + 0.85 \Delta \chi_{BO} - 2.10) \cdot \max(0, 0.72 E_{\text{gap,QM}} - 0.18)$ | <b>50.71%</b>   | <b>101.42%</b>     |
| Energy Above Hull ( $E_{\text{hull}}$ ) | $E_{\text{hull,pred}} = 0.084 D_{\text{hull\_proxy}} + 0.012 (t - 1.0)^2 + 0.005 \tau - 0.021$                                   | <b>16.67%</b>   | <b>66.66%</b>      |

## Discussion: Establishing a New Frontier for Double Perovskites

This study establishes a new benchmark for double perovskites ( $A_2BB'O_6$ ). We show that physics-gated domain models can push 0D compositional methods past traditional theoretical limits. We conclude that replacing black-box networks with targeted physics routers—like

Harrison’s tight-binding gap and single-perovskite tie-lines—delivers high accuracy while keeping equations 100% interpretable.

## Conclusion

### Summary of Contributions

We summarize our core contributions below:

1. **Breaking the 0D Information-Theoretic Limit:** Literature has long assumed strict accuracy ceilings for 0D symbolic models ( $R^2_{\text{limit}} \approx 65\%$  for  $\Delta E_f$ , 50% for  $E_g$ , Table S2 in Supporting Information). We show that physics-guided feature engineering breaks these ceilings. Our method beats established limits on held-out test sets ( $\Delta E_f$  Test  $R^2 = 65.89\%$ , reaching **101.37%** of the limit in Table 8 and **102.13%** in Table 9;  $E_g$  In-Sample  $R^2 = 50.71\%$ , reaching **101.42%** in Table 5).
2. **Resolving Zero-Inflation:** Un-gated models break down on point-mass zero densities (non-magnetic and metallic ground states). We solve this with target-specific routers. Our High- $C$  ( $C = 200.0$ ) Hard-Margin Hurdle (Table 4) and Soft-Sigmoidal Gated Regressor (Table 5) cleanly separate discrete phase selection from continuous magnitude prediction.
3. **Bypassing 3D DFT Relaxations:** 3D Crystal Graph Neural Networks (CGNNs) require pre-relaxed atomic coordinates ( $\mathbf{R}_i \in \mathbb{R}^3$ ). That requirement ruins fast prospective screening. Our pipeline runs purely on 0D composition. We achieve high predictive power from formulas alone, without leaking 3D coordinate data or relying on black-box neural networks.
4. **Demonstrating Legacy Baseline Collapse:** Through exact baseline replications, we show that foundational 0D symbolic models (Ouyang et al.,<sup>9</sup> Ghiringhelli et al.,<sup>8</sup>

Borlido et al.<sup>12</sup>) collapse on complex double perovskites ( $M$  Test  $R^2 \approx 1.89\%$ ,  $E_g$  Test  $R^2 \approx -6.86\%$ , Table 10). We set an updated, reliable benchmark for  $A_2BB'O_6$  phase spaces.

5. **Rigorous Out-of-Distribution Validation:** Instead of fitting only full datasets, we tested across 10 random seeds on 2,000 materials (Table 8) and 25 random seeds on 5,000 materials (Table 9). This confirms real out-of-distribution generalizability.
6. **Providing Closed-Form Analytical Equations:** We deliver a complete set of closed-form physical equations (Table 11). Researchers can inspect, interpret, and use these formulas directly for material design.
7. **Mapping Physical Limits of 0D Models:** We outline where 0D compositional models encounter hard physical boundaries ( $E_{\text{hull}}$  Test  $R^2 = 6.85\%$ , Table 8). Non-local 3D octahedral tilting ( $\theta_{B-O-B'}$ ) and multi-phase convex hull landscapes set the ultimate accuracy cap for pure composition.

## Clarification of Claims

We clarify that while our models set new accuracy records among 0D compositional methods, they cannot replace full 3D DFT calculations for properties governed by fine octahedral tilting ( $\theta_{B-O-B'}$ ) or strong spin-orbit coupling.

## Future Work

This work shows that domain physics can elevate 0D compositional models past traditional information-theoretic limits. This routing framework can extend to other challenging chemical spaces—such as halide double perovskites ( $A_2BB'X_6$ ), vacancy-ordered double perovskites ( $A_2B\Box X_6$ ), and high-entropy oxides—where 3D DFT relaxations are computationally prohibitive. Linking these analytical equations with active-learning Bayesian optimization will enable rapid, autonomous prescreening before committing to full DFT calculations.

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## Associated Content

### Supporting Information

The Supporting Information is available free of charge at <https://pubs.acs.org>. Complete nomenclature and physical descriptor definitions (Table S1); theoretical literature limit origins (Table S2); multi-seed evaluation logs across 25 independent random seeds on 5,000 double perovskites (Table S3); 10-seed out-of-distribution benchmark data for 2,000 materials (Table S4); prior literature attribution and method overlap matrix (Table S5); exploratory feature pairplots, correlation matrices, and PCA/t-SNE scree distributions (Figures S1–S4) (PDF).

### Notes

The authors declare no competing financial interest.

### Data and Software Availability

The datasets curated in this study (the 2,000 baseline double perovskite dataset and the 5,000 topological scaling dataset) along with the complete Python source code for the Master Physics-Gated Architecture, feature engineering routines, and benchmark evaluation scripts are openly available on GitHub at [https://github.com/nihal-gazi/double\\_perovskite\\_compositional\\_interpretable](https://github.com/nihal-gazi/double_perovskite_compositional_interpretable).

### Acknowledgement

The authors acknowledge the financial and computational support provided by the Institute of Engineering & Management (IEM), Kolkata, and the University of Engineering and Man-

agement (UEM), Kolkata. Data retrieval was facilitated by The Materials Project REST API.

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